



Kids enrich your life, but it's important to understand that they are not free. The financial responsibility they bring with them is immense. These are my children, Savannah and Trevor, when they were young.

(Kevin O'Leary)

Money Mistake: You're Not Sure You Can Afford Kids

THE FIX: CRUNCH SOME BABY NUMBERS

However lovely it is to have kids, they are financial drains: the shoes, the clothes, food, day care, gasoline, prom dresses, ski trips, lunch money. It doesn't stop for almost two decades. And now, with so many of them moving back home because the economy keeps kicking them to the curb, you have to ask yourself if you can really afford to raise one or two of them for a quarter of a century. As you've read, the financial burden of a grown kid who doesn't contribute to the family is huge. Plus, with half of all marriages ending in divorce, you also have to factor in the cost of single parenting, child support, and raising kids in two homes.